

AN INDEPENDENT STUDENT RESEARCH COMMUNITY

How the program works.

How students research the way AI is really used across finance — the shape of the eight weeks, and what you walk away with.

Fully remote

8 weeks

~8–10 hrs / week

Capstone project

The future of finance learns AI first.

Independent · student-founded · not affiliated with any university, employer, or fund.

● THE MISSION

We're figuring out how AI is really used across finance.

Applied Intelligence Collective gives students the structure, environment, and accountability to research how AI is actually being used across finance. We believe that when students come together with a shared vision, the learning compounds and helps prepare us for our careers.

Bring what you're curious about.

Members pick the corner of finance + AI they actually want to learn — and take it from there.

1

Efficient uses

Where AI genuinely creates an edge.

2

The ROI gap

Where cost and hype outrun the payoff.

3

Real workflows

How people actually use it, day to day.

● THE ARC

Eight weeks, start to showcase.

WEEK 1

Plan & Scope

01

Set your topic and goals, and learn what makes research good.

WEEKS 2-6

Research & Publish

02

The weekly rhythm — research, ship, present, repeat.

WEEKS 7-8

Synthesize & Present

03

Final paper + deck, delivered at the Research Showcase.

Week 1 is about more than planning.

Set your topic and goals, and dig into how good research is actually done — before you list the firms and people you want to reach out to.

● HOW IT STARTS

What week 1 actually looks like.

1

Choose your research focus

Pick the corner of finance + AI you're curious about — it's yours to run with.

2

Set goals and a rough plan

Decide what you want to learn and how you'll get there. Rough is fine.

3

Collaborate with your team

Talk with your group about how to make the most of this experience together.

4

Study what makes research good

Look at what separates research worth reading from research that isn't.

5

Sketch your eight-week arc

Rough out how your topic could build week to week across the 8 weeks.

6

Say hello to your team lead

Introduce yourself and ask questions early — they're your first stop.

● EVERY SINGLE WEEK

Three things, every week.

A simple, repeatable rhythm. Small enough to keep up, real enough to build a portfolio.

1

300-word brief

A tight, sourced summary of what you found.

2

LinkedIn + infographic

An excerpt plus an infographic that visualizes your research.

3

Research deck

A few slides you present at the weekly Zoom.

A rhythm we keep refining.

These three are the core — the exact shape keeps evolving as we learn what works, and members' ideas drive that.

● WHERE THE EVIDENCE COMES FROM

Four ways to find real evidence.

1

Conversations & calls

Reach out to people you know — or don't yet — and ask for 20 minutes to learn how they actually use AI.

2

Company filings & disclosures

10-Ks, earnings calls, and investor materials increasingly disclose how firms are using AI.

3

LinkedIn, Reddit & more

Done well, these surface real practitioner opinions and workflows you won't find anywhere official.

4

Whatever else works

There's no fixed list beyond this — if you find a good source we haven't mentioned, use it.

Combine a few of these.

The strongest research triangulates — don't lean on just one medium.

● GETTING THE WORD OUT

Where your research goes.

1

LinkedIn

Excerpts each week, rotating who's featured — everyone gets credited.

2

Instagram

Posts alongside LinkedIn, same rotation across the cohort.

3

The website

A couple 300-word briefs published weekly, plus final papers as they're finished.

4

A weekly newsletter

In the works — a roundup that pulls together research from across the cohort.

This is our starting point.

We're building credibility and experience first — funding and outside publication, like journals, come next.

● THE STRUCTURE

Individual research. Collective growth.

Three different layers of collaboration, each with its own purpose.

1

You research on your own

Your topic, your questions, your output —
the research itself is individual.

2

You share with your team

Present and compare notes with your
group each week — that's where you learn
and grow from each other.

3

We shape the program together

As a whole cohort, we're reforming and
adapting this as we go — figuring out
together what actually works.

This keeps evolving.

That's by design — we're figuring out the best version of this together, all cohort long.

- YOU'RE ON A TEAM

Organized into research groups.

Members are grouped with peers and a student team lead — a weekly space to collaborate and share work. Groups map to broad areas of finance, not to a fixed topic.



Investment Banking

Advisory, capital markets, and dealmaking.



Wealth Management & Investing

Advisory, planning, and portfolio work.



Corporate Finance

Treasury, FP&A, and the finance function.



Real Estate

Investment, development, and capital.

Your group isn't a box for your topic — pick whatever corner of finance + AI excites you. Each group's student team lead is your first stop for feedback and support.

● THE APPROACH

Real work, real flexibility.

1

Fully remote

Everything runs on Zoom and a shared Drive — plus optional in-person events when we can.

2

~8–10 hrs / week

Enough to build something real — built around your job or internship, not competing with it.

3

Open-ended, on purpose

We keep the structure light so we can learn from members and pull in everyone's ideas for the best way to research and write things worth reading.

4

We handle the formatting

Don't spend your time formatting or designing — AI agents turn your research into branded posts. Put that energy into the research itself and what you're learning.

● BY THE SHOWCASE

What you'll walk away with.

1

A published portfolio
Briefs and posts with your name on them.

2

A capstone paper + deck
Your final research, presented at the Research Showcase.

3

Real AI-in-finance fluency
A grounded view of how the industry uses AI.

4

Leadership experience
Small groups mean real room to lead, not just contribute.

5

A growing network
Your cohort, your team leads, and the professionals you reach out to.

6

Startup-style experience
Room to bring your own ideas and build something from scratch.

And we keep groups small.
Real space to actually earn every one of these.

The future of finance learns AI first.

An independent, student-founded research community studying how AI is really used across finance — what works, what's overhyped, and the workflows behind it.

appliedintelligencecollective.com

Independent · student-founded · not affiliated with any university, employer, or fund.